



Which yellow, Mr. LeWitt?

Reconstruction of Conceptual Artwork Sol LeWitt Wall Drawing #95

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Contemporary Art

Conservation and Restoration of Cultral Heritage
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Introduction

Motivation and a question

- American conceptual artist Sol LeWitt (1928-2007) provided instructions for wall drawing as authentic artwork.
- Installation of his artwork is inevitably executed as a reconstruction, which results in diverse appearances, depending on the performer's interpretations of the instruction.
- What is intended by the artist's instruction exactly?

Methods

- Art technological source research, literature study, practical experiments.

Relevance to the conservation field

- In conceptual art conservation, understanding the idea contained in the exterior of an artwork is a critical part.
- Experiments target to understand the artist's intention.

Sources

- Certificate for *Wall Drawing #95*¹

On a wall divided vertically into 15 equal parts, vertical lines, not straight, using four colors in all one-, two-, three-, and four-part combinations.

Red. yellow. blue. black pencil

The whole instruction in the certificate.

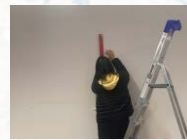
- Articles written by the artist *Paragraphs on conceptual art*.²
- Different works of the artist *Wall Drawing #11*³ and *#46*⁴: understanding his thoughts on conceptual art and intention.

Reconstruction Methodology

Dividing the wall: 3 different ways to draw 15 equal parts



- Beam projector
Projecting digitally designed file to the wall to draw lines for 15 equal parts.



- Ruler, balancing tool and masking tape
Measuring the whole dimension of the wall, dividing, and checking with the balancing tool.



- Ruler, thread, and masking tape
Measuring the dimensions of the parts and attaching threads top to bottom direction.

Experiments condition setting: colors and lines

- 1) Red, yellow, blue, and black 4 color parts in repeated order.
- 2) Same color sets with continued vertical lines in one part.
- 3) Same color sets by color pencils from another manufacturer.
- 4) Same color sets with a different dimension of drawing size.
- 5) Same color sets with a different density of lines.
- 6) Blue, black, yellow, and red 4 color parts in repeated order.
- 7) Irregular orders of the single-color parts.
- 8) Each parts have more than 2 color lines.
- 9) Final experiment on the wall with the different colors /order combinations, line shapes, and the surface conditions.

* Based on the experiment 1, variations were added. Experiments 1-8 were executed on paper.

Conclusion & Future Research

- Experiments show that many appearances can be made by the instruction which is open to interpretation. For example, 'yellow' has many variations already.
- Sol LeWitt intended a variety of installation results, while his conceptual artwork(instruction) stays intact. It proves that the idea of the artwork is essential rather than the materiality in the conceptual art.
- Future experiment: Comparison between different instructions.

Acknowledgement & Author

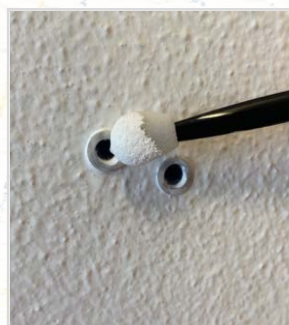
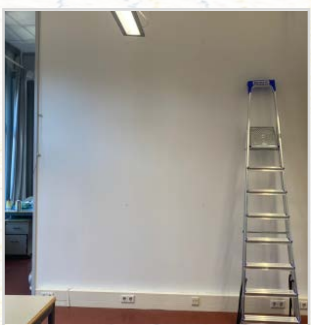
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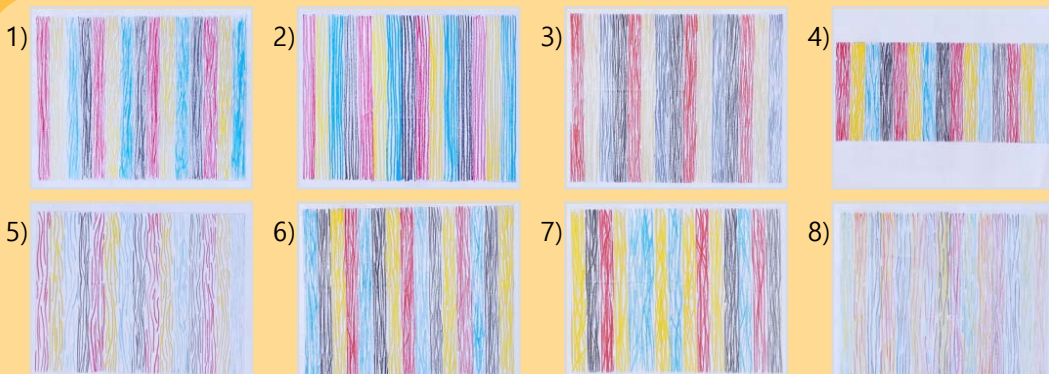


Preparation for Reconstruction



- Materials & Tools : white wall, ladder, papers, 2 types of color pencils, balancing tool, masking tape, beam projector, thread.

9 Results _ 'some' of hundreds possible drawings



Experiment 9: dimension 112cm x 88cm. 15 kinds of color combinations and various line shapes (long strokes, short strokes, and continued) were executed on the wall painted with white paint, referring to a digitally printed color layout.

Reference : ¹Modern Art Museum of Fort Worth, *BEING THERE ART ASSIGNMENT 4 SOL LEWITT WALL DRAWING #50A, 1970*. Modern Art Museum of Fort Worth, Texas, U.S.A. March 2021. ²LeWitt, Sol. *Paragraphs on conceptual art*. Artforum Vol 5. No.10, 1967 : 79-83. ³Massachusetts Museum of Contemporary Art, *WALL DRAWING 11*, May 1969. ⁴Massachusetts Museum of Contemporary Art, *WALL DRAWING 46*, May 1970.

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